

“Employment First” Resource List

Revised June, 2011



Over the last few years the term “employment first” has become widely used to describe how state and local systems across the country articulate the values and philosophy which undergird employment services and supports available to individuals and families. An employment first approach means integrated individual employment is offered before other service options, and that community employment is supported as the priority outcome in policy, practice, and quality management. While the term has become popular in the developmental disability field, the philosophy of Employment First is being applied differently from state to state. Some of these variations are due to differences in rate/reimbursement methodologies and service definitions, and are also due to the catalysts behind employment first in individual states, which include policymakers, legislators, and grassroots groups. In some states, employment first has focused exclusively on intellectual and development disability systems, in other cases employment first has focused on the entire disability community. This list is intended to provide the reader with a broad set of resources and to illustrate the immense range of options in play around the country. The resources below represent both state initiatives and the work of grass-roots coalitions seeking to improve employment outcomes.

General Information

1. APSE PUBLICATIONS

- ❖ **APSE Employment First Statement:** Statement outlining principles of Employment First
www.apse.org/docs/APSE%20Employment%20First%20Statement%20-%20FINAL-1.pdf
- ❖ **APSE Employment First White Paper:** “Establishing a National Employment First Agenda” paper from APSE
www.apse.org/docs/Employment%20First%20Paper%20609%5B1%5D.pdf
- ❖ **APSE Connections-Employment First:** Article from JTPR APSE Connections advocating a national Employment First agenda

2. ALLIANCE FOR FULL PARTICIPATION

- ❖ **The Alliance for Full Participation (AFP) site** contains a number of Employment First documents and updates from various states on their Employment First activities
www.allianceforfullparticipation.org

3. NASDDS Article – Workers First

- ❖ **Article from June 2009 Community Services Reporter,** published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services providing an overview of Employment First efforts
[www.nasdds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst\(Moseley\).pdf](http://www.nasdds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst(Moseley).pdf)

4. NTAR Leadership Center Blog

- ❖ **Blog post on Employment First by Wendy Parent, Kansas University**
<http://ntarseedingchange.blogspot.com/2010/03/employment-first.html>

5.ODEP-USDOL Employment First Memo

- ❖ **January 2009 memo** from the US Department of Labor Office of Disability Employment Policy stressing importance of Employment First
www.dol.gov/odep/events/employmentfirst/employmentfirst.htm

6. SELN PUBLICATIONS

- ❖ **SELN Employment First Publication:** “Q & A’s on State Employment First Policies” - publication from the State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) providing an overview of Employment First, and specific efforts in Colorado, Florida, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Tennessee, Washington State, Georgia, Minnesota, and Indiana
http://selnmembers.org/images/stories/site_documents/dmr%20request%20employment%20policy%203-08rev.pdf
- ❖ **SELN Maintaining Focus:** Article from March 2009 Community Services Reporter, published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services “Maintaining a Focus on Employment in Tough Economic Times” – intended to encourage state systems to maintain focus on employment despite current economic conditions
www.nasddds.org/pdf/MaintainingFocusOnEmployment.pdf

State Specific Information

1. ARKANSAS

- ❖ **Governor’s Executive Order:** Executive order establishing the Arkansas Employment First Initiative
www.arkdisabilityrights.org/doc/eo_1017.pdf

2. CALIFORNIA

- ❖ **CA Employment First Legislation Overview:** Overview of AB 287 from California State Council on Developmental Disabilities - www.scdd.ca.gov/Legislation/AB287/Learnabout-AB287_9-09combined.pdf
- ❖ **CA Legislation (passed):** Text of AB 287, California’s Legislation on Employment First, signed into law in October 2009 www.leginfo.ca.gov/pub/09-10/bill/asm/ab_0251-0300/ab_287_bill_20091011_chaptered.pdf

3. CONNECTICUT

- ❖ **Connecticut Department of Developmental Services self-determination newsletter** discussing state’s Employment First efforts www.ct.gov/dds/lib/dds/self_determination/newsletters/sd_newsletter_june_2008.pdf

4. DELAWARE

- ❖ **Delaware Employment First Statement:** Statement from Delaware Division of Developmental Disabilities Services on Employment First
www.dhss.delaware.gov/ddds/emp_first.html
- ❖ **Delaware DDDS Newsletter:** Newsletter from Delaware DDDS with further details on Employment First
www.dhss.delaware.gov/ddds/files/learn_curve_june09.pdf

5. GEORGIA

- ❖ **Employment First Georgia Website:** www.employmentfirstgeorgia.org

6. INDIANA

- ❖ **IN APSE Employment First 2009 follow-up:** Summary of follow-up items from 2005 Indiana Employment First Summit www.inapse.org/styles/inapse/defiles/summit%20update%2012-15-09.pdf
- ❖ **IN Employment First Fact Sheet:** Fact sheet summarizing 2005 Indiana Employment First Summit www.apse.org/docs/IN_APSE_empl_first_fact_sheet.pdf

7. IOWA

- ❖ **Iowa's Employment First Initiative:** A Call for Change of Historical Proportion: Fall 2009 white paper outlining vision for an Employment First initiative in Iowa: www.allianceforfullparticipation.org/component/content/article/196-iowas-employment-first-initiative
- ❖ **Iowa Employment First Initiative Summary Points:** One-page summary of rationale for Employment First in Iowa

8. KANSAS

- ❖ **Kansas Employment First Legislation:** Text of Kansas House Bill 2336 which establishes a statewide policy of employment first for all people with disabilities. Bill was signed into law in May 2011 www.kslegislature.org/li/b2011_12/year1/measures/documents/hb2336_enrolled.pdf
- ❖ **Kansas Employment First Summary:** Summary of Kansas Employment First efforts and link to materials www.workinghealthy.org/employmentfirst.html
- ❖ **Kansas Employment First Flyer:** Flyer promoting Employment First in Kansas www.workinghealthy.org/downloads/EmploymentFirstFlyer.pdf
- ❖ **Kansas Report – Employment First Workgroup:** May 2009 from Employment First Initiative Work Group www.apse.org/docs/aaaemployment_first_work_group_initial_report.pdf
- ❖ **Kansas Executive Orders:** Executive orders from the Governor of Kansas issued 8/26/10, related to employment of individuals in the community: <http://governor.ks.gov/issues-a-initiatives/executive-orders/762-10-10>
<http://governor.ks.gov/issues-a-initiatives/executive-orders/761-10-09>

9. LOUISIANA

- ❖ Employment First policy statement from the Louisiana Office of Citizens with Developmental Disabilities http://new.dhh.louisiana.gov/assets/docs/OCDD/Other/Employment_First_MEMO.pdf

10. MARYLAND

- ❖ **Development Disabilities Administration Position Statement on Employment Services** http://dhmh.maryland.gov/dda_md/Training/DDA91809.pdf
- ❖ **Employment First Overview:** Overview of Maryland's Development Disabilities Administration Employment First initiative www.reinventingquality.org/docs/ColleenGauruder-08.pdf

11. MASSACHUSETTS

- ❖ **MA Employment First Policy:** 2010 policy issuance from Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services
- ❖ **MA DDS RFQ:** Excerpts from 2009 Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services service provider solicitation, highlighting a shift in Massachusetts to an Employment First Policy

12. MINNESOTA

- ❖ **MN Employment First Summit Report I:** Report of 2007 MN Employment First Summit - A Manifesto on the Employment of Minnesotans with Disabilities in the Integrated, Competitive Workforce
www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report.pdf
- ❖ **MN Employment First Summit Report II:** Report of 2008 MN Employment First Summit - A Progress Report on Employment First Performance in Minnesota
www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report-Summit-2.pdf
- ❖ **Minnesota Employment First Web Links:**
 - Minnesota Employment Policy Initiative Website: www.mn-epi.org/main
 - Minnesota Employment Training & Technical Assistance Website: www.mntat.org/main
 - Employment First Blogs: <http://employment1st.blogspot.com>, www.mn-epi.blogspot.com

13. MISSOURI

- ❖ **January 2011 Employment First Policy**, issued by the Missouri Department of Mental Health, Division of Developmental Disabilities — www.dmh.mo.gov/docs/dd/employmentpolicyfinal.doc

14. NEW MEXICO

- ❖ **Webinar: “Making Employment First a Reality in NM” webinar and text:**
www.health.state.nm.us/DDSD/meaningfullife/EmployFirstRsrcs.htm

15. NORTH CAROLINA

- ❖ **APSE Article:** Article from North Carolina APSE calling for an Employment First Policy
www.ncapse.org/WhitePaperEmploymentFirst.pdf

16. OREGON

- ❖ **Oregon DDS Employment First Policy:** Oregon Office of Developmental Disability Services Policy on employment for working age individuals
www.dhs.state.or.us/dd/supp_emp/employment-first-policy.pdf
- ❖ **Article on Employment First:** Opinion piece published in Oregon newspapers
<http://theportlander.com/2010/03/16/employment-first-for-all-oregonians>
- ❖ **Oregon Employment First Plan:** Plan developed for implementation of Employment First in Oregon
https://www.sidestreetshop.com/stores/195/libraries/articulate/wise_or_ef_recommendations_paper_1_28_2011_final_w_o_copyright_notice_1_.pdf

17. OKLAHOMA

- ❖ **DDS Employment Policy:** Oklahoma Developmental Disabilities Services employment policy, stating that the optimal goal of waiver services is full-time employment in the community
www.okdhs.org/library/policy/oac317/040/07/0001000.htm

18. PENNSYLVANIA

- ❖ **PA Employment Legislation:** State legislation that mandates access to community employment:
www.pacode.com/secure/data/055/chapter6000/subchapKtoc.html

- ❖ **PA Employment Policy—General:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation on community employment as a priority—
www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/misc/00-05-07.pdf
- ❖ **PA Employment Policy – ICFs/MR:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Department of Public welfare on supporting community employment for individuals living in Intermediate Care Facilities for Individuals with Mental Retardation, indicating community employment as a priority without regard to level of disability
www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/icf/00-06-08.pdf
- ❖ **PA Employment Policy – 1990:** 1990 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation directing that community employment be considered as a service option before less integrated, more restricted options
www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/misc/6000-90-06.pdf

19. RHODE ISLAND

- ❖ **Employment First Summit Report** - Report of Employment First Summit held in March 2010
www.rhodesoindependence.org/docs/final%20summary%20report.pdf
- ❖ **Employment First Policy White Paper** – Paper discussing options for Employment First legislation in Rhode Island
www.rhodesoindependence.org/docs/Policy%20White%20Paper%20-%20Final%20%20-%202011.23.10.pdf
- ❖ **1115 Waiver Group Report** – September 2009 paper which contains initial proposal for Rhode Island to be an Employment First state - www.ohhs.ri.gov/documents/documents09/Employmt_Wkgrp_recs.pdf

20. TENNESSEE

- ❖ **ARC of TN Statement.** Statement from ARC of Tennessee in support of Employment First
www.thearctn.org/Employment.php
- ❖ **TN DMRS Employment First Statement.** 2003 statement of support from the Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services in support of Tennessee's Employment First! Initiative
- ❖ **TN DMRS Newsletter 07.** 2007 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services newsletter containing article on employment first – pp. 3-5
http://tennessee.gov/dids/newsroom/publications/personally_speaking/march_07.pdf
- ❖ **TN DMRS Provider Manual Excerpt.** Excerpt from 2005 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services provider manual regarding Employment First, and requirements for vocational evaluation (situational assessment) every three years. To find this excerpt, go to the full manual and search for “Employment First”
www.state.tn.us/dids/provider_agencies/Provider%20Manual.pdf
- ❖ **TN Employment First Overview.** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Tennessee's Employment First policy
www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=202

21. TEXAS

- ❖ **Legislation (proposed):** Text of Texas House Bill 785 requiring that employment services be structured to ensure employment of people with disabilities in integrated settings. Current status (6/10) is that bill has not been acted on. -
www.statesurge.com/bills/hb-785-texas-452277

22. UTAH

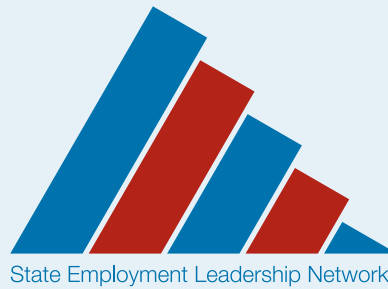
- ❖ **Legislation (proposed):** Text of proposed Utah legislation that requires that employment be the first priority for individuals with disabilities receiving publicly funded supports.
<http://le.utah.gov/~2011/bills/hbillint/hb0240.htm>

23. WASHINGTON STATE

- ❖ **ICI Pub-Washington WAAP:** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Washington's Working Age Adult Policy
www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=222
- ❖ **Washington State Policy:** Washington Division of Developmental Disabilities Working Age Adult Policy
www.dshs.wa.gov/pdf/adsa/ddd/policies/policy4.11.pdf

24. WISCONSIN

- ❖ **WI Employment First Flyer:** Wisconsin APSE Employment First flyer
- ❖ **WI Employment First Plan 2010:** Wisconsin Employment First plan developed in 2010
- ❖ **WI Employment First Rationale-FAQ:** Wisconsin APSE rationale and frequently asked questions regarding Employment First
www.wiapse.org/WI%20Employment%20First%20Initiative%20Rationale.doc
- ❖ **WI Mission and Values Statement:** Wisconsin Employment First Mission and Values Statement, asking individuals to commit to Employment First



SELN Working Document

The State Employment Leadership Network is a network of 20 state intellectual and developmental disability agencies working together to improve employment outcomes for individuals. Working documents contain information collected in response to state requests, and federal, state and local initiatives of interest to the SELN membership. They are intended to share work in progress but may not be a comprehensive analysis or compilation. Working documents are updated over time as information changes.

The SELN is a joint program of the Institute for Community Inclusion at UMass Boston and the National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services.

Learn More and Get Involved

To learn more about the SELN and how membership can benefit your organization, contact:

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Copies of items that are not available on the world wide web can be obtained from David Hoff by sending an email to david.hoff@umb.edu; phone: 617-287-4308